12.1 Programming a to-do application

DynamoDB is a key-value store that organizes your data into tables. For example, you can have a table to store your users and another table to store tasks. The items contained in the table are identified by a unique key. An item could be a user or a task; think of an item as a row in a relational database.

To minimize the overhead of a programming language, you'll use Node.js/JavaScript to create a small to-do application, nodetodo, which you can use via the terminal on your local machine. nodetodo uses DynamoDB as a database and comes with the following features:

- Creates and deletes users
- Creates and deletes tasks
- Marks tasks as done
- Gets a list of all tasks with various filters

To implement an intuitive CLI, nodetodo uses *docopt*, a command-line interface description language, to describe the CLI interface. The supported commands follow:

- `user-add`—Adds a new user to nodetodo
- `user-rm`—Removes a user
- `user-ls`—Lists users
- `user`—Shows the details of a single user
- `task-add`—Adds a new task to nodetodo
- `task-rm`—Removes a task
- `task-ls`—Lists user tasks with various filters